

Features	QEMU	Oracle VM VirtualBox	VMware Player	Parallels Desktop
Definition	QEMU (short for 'Quick EMULATOR') is emulation software that provides a set of dynamic device models that enable it to run a variety of unmodified guest operating systems.	Oracle VM VirtualBox is a cross-platform virtualisation software meant for x86-based systems.	VMware Player is an x86 virtualisation software application made by VMware, Inc. It is installed on an existing host OS as an application. This host application allows additional guest operating systems to be loaded and run, each with its own virtual environment.	Parallels Desktop for Mac by Parallels Inc is software providing hardware virtualisation for Mac PCs with Intel processors.
Method of operation	Paravirtualisation and porting or hardware virtualisation. Runs on x86, ARM, Sparc64-32, OpenRISC	x86 Virtualisation	x86 Virtualisation	x86 Virtualisation
Host CPU	x86, x86-64, IA-64, PowerPC, SPARC 32/64, ARM, S/390, MIPS	x86, x86-64, Intel VT-x, AMD-V	x86, x86-64, Intel VT-x, AMD-V	x86, Intel VT-x
Guest CPU	x86, x86-64, Alpha, ARM, CRIS, LM32, M68k, MicroBlaze, MIPS, OpenRisc32, PowerPC, S/390, SH4, SPARC 32/64, Unicore32 and Xtensa	x86 and x86-64	x86 and x86-64	x86 and x86-64
Supported host OS	Windows, Linux, Mac OS X, Solaris, FreeBSD, OpenBSD and BeOS	Windows, Linux, Mac OS X x86, Solaris, FreeBSD and eComStation	Windows and Linux	Mac OS X
Supported guest OS	Windows, Linux, Mac OS X, Solaris, FreeBSD, OpenBSD, BeOS and others; runs arbitrary OS	DOS, Linux, Mac OS X Server, FreeBSD, Haiku, OS/2, Solaris, Syllable, Windows and others; runs arbitrary OS	Windows, Linux, Solaris, FreeBSD, OSx86 (as FreeBSD), virtual appliances, Netware, OS/2, SCO, BeOS, Haiku, Darwin and others; runs arbitrary OS	Windows, Linux, FreeBSD, OS/2, eComStation, DOS, Solaris and Haiku
Provides guest OS drivers	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Snapshots facility	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Commercial support availability	No	Yes (with a commercial licence)	Yes	Yes
Licensing	GPL/LGPL	GPL version 2; full version with extra enterprise features is proprietary	Proprietary, free of charge for personal non-commercial use	Proprietary
Costing	Free	Free	Free	Commercial
Product Link	http://goo.gl/890fO	http://goo.gl/HLYfh	http://goo.gl/K0g5F	http://goo.gl/BD825